PORTFOLIO · 2026

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Cybersecurity analyst
track: SOC, IAM,
and security operations

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WHAT THIS PACKET IS

A hiring packet for junior SOC, security analyst, and IAM-adjacent roles. It opens with the foundation I work from — the eight domains, CIA, PII and SPII, OWASP, audit scope, risk, and control categories — then the labs I can walk.

HOW TO READ THE PROJECTS

These are portfolio demonstrations, built from hands-on practice aligned with the Google Cybersecurity Certificate. They are not presented as paid production employment. Each write-up is the work sample I would walk a hiring manager through.

TARGET ROLES

SOC Analyst I	Alert triage, ticket notes, escalation
Security Analyst	Access review, asset questions, controls
IAM Analyst	Least privilege, joiner-mover-leaver
IT Security Associate	Hardening, logging, user-facing guidance

CREDENTIALS

Foundations of Cybersecurity

Google on Coursera, completed Sep 30, 2026. ID 22W5X58597QD.

Full Google certificate / CISSP

Both in progress. Course 1 is issued. Neither is claimed as finished.

POSITIONING LINE

I defend systems by tightening access, reading logs,
and writing risk so the business can decide.

APPLICATION FORM · PROFILE FROM SEPTEMBER 19

Portfolio form

Contact, availability, strengths, and the four labs — one page

FIELD	ANSWER
Name	Desmond R. Whitlock
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Work mode	Remote, and Atlanta on-site
Target	Junior SOC, security analyst, IAM-adjacent

Strengths I lead with

- Communication — the note is clear enough for a manager who was not in the room.
- Problem solving — fact, inference, and unknown stay in different sentences.
- Time management — scope first, then evidence, then the finding.
- Perspective — I check the assumption before I trust the tool.

Labs on this form

Lab	What it shows
Permission audit	Domain 5, IAM, 13%. Least privilege on a Linux host.
Unknown device	Domain 7, Security Operations, 13%. Monitor, isolate, or escalate.
PII / SPII page	Domain 2, Asset Security, 10%. Handling rule for staff.
Mini risk register	Domain 1, Risk Management, 16%. Five owned risks.

CREDENTIAL ON THE FORM

Foundations of Cybersecurity, Google on Coursera, September 30, 2026.
Verify: coursera.org/account/accomplishments/verify/22W5X58597QD

CAPABILITY SNAPSHOT

What I can do on day one

Junior roles do not need a person who has run a SOC. They need someone who can follow a process, write a clear note, and not make access worse. That is the bar this packet is built to.

Linux

System hardening and log review. Users, groups, sudo, file permissions, service accounts, and basic host triage.

SQL

Querying and auditing. Pull who accessed what, filter by time, and check whether a record matches the ticket.

Python

Small automation. Parse a log, flag a repeated pattern, or turn a checklist into a repeatable script.

Security ops

Phishing recognition, alert context, escalation notes, and the difference between a guess and a finding.

IAM thinking

Least privilege, separation of duties, joiner-mover-leaver, and standing admin access as a risk.

Risk writing

Likelihood, impact, owner, and a treatment a manager can accept, reduce, or transfer.

HOW I WORK

Write the note first	A finding without time, asset, and next step is not a finding. I document as I go.
Separate fact from guess	Observed, inferred, and unknown stay in different sentences.
Ask who owns it	A control without an owner dies. Every recommendation names a person or a team.
Plain language up	Security that only security understands does not get funded or followed.

TRANSFERABLE STRENGTHS I LEAD WITH

Communication, problem solving, time management, and a habit of checking the assumption before the tool. Useful when the ticket is messy and the asset owner is not in the room.

FOUNDATION · LEVEL 1

CIA triad, PII, and SPII

Domain 1, Security and Risk Management, 16% · Domain 2, Asset Security, 10%

A control only matters if it protects confidentiality, integrity, or availability. If the asset is a person, I mark PII or SPII before I talk about the control.

CIA

Goal	Plain meaning	Broken when
Confidentiality	Only the right people can see it.	Open share, emailed password, excess admin.
Integrity	Data and system are still correct.	Unlogged edit, swapped file, bad input accepted.
Availability	The system is there when the job needs it.	Ransomware, no owner on the backup, no restore test.

PII and SPII

PII identifies a person. SPII is the subset that can cause serious harm if it leaks. The combination raises the level: a name alone is weak; a name plus SSN is SPII.

Type	Examples	Level 1 rule
PII	Name with email or phone, employee ID, account number, address.	Need a reason. Approved store only. Do not paste into chat.
SPII	SSN, government ID, bank or card data, health data, credentials.	Fewer people. No casual email. Escalate on exposure.

If it leaves the approved place

- Stop further sharing. Do not forward it so someone else can look.
- Write what left, when, and who received it. Facts only.
- Tell the named owner. Do not investigate past the first facts.

BEST PRACTICE

Classify before access. SPII is never emailed. Name the CIA goal, then the control.

FOUNDATION · LEVEL 1

OWASP

Domain 8, Software Development Security, 10% · Open Worldwide Application Security Project

OWASP publishes the common web-application risk classes. At this level I use the Top 10 to sort a finding and name the control. I do not need an exploit to write the note.

Risk class	Level 1 meaning	Control direction
Broken access control	User reaches what the role should not.	Deny by default. Check every request.
Cryptographic failures	Secrets or sensitive data exposed.	Protect in transit and at rest.
Injection	Input is treated as a command.	Validate input. Parameterized queries.
Insecure design	Unsafe before it was built.	Threat-model the flow first.
Security misconfiguration	Defaults and extra features left on.	Harden. Remove unused features.
Vulnerable components	Old library or plugin, known-bad.	Inventory components. Patch on a schedule.
Auth failures	Weak login, no MFA, session lives.	MFA, lockout, short sessions.
Integrity failures	Update or pipeline can be changed.	Sign artifacts. Limit who publishes.
Logging failures	Event happened and nobody saw it.	Log auth and admin actions. Alert.
SSRF	Server called an internal address.	Allow-list outbound. Block metadata IPs.

BEST PRACTICE

Deny by default. Parameterized queries. Patch the component. Log the auth failure.
Sort the finding on this list, then name that control.

FOUNDATION · LEVEL 1

Security audit with a team, and scope

Domain 6, Security Assessment and Testing, 12%

An audit asks whether the stated control is actually in place. It is not a hunt for every flaw. The team agrees the question, the boundary, and who writes the finding.

Small-team roles

Role	Owns
Lead	Scope, schedule, and the final call on a finding.
Control owner	Runs the control day to day. Source of truth, not the accused.
Evidence	Configs, queries, tickets. Labels fact versus inference.
Writer	One format: condition, evidence, risk, recommendation, owner.
Reviewer	Note matches the evidence before it leaves the team.

Scope is five lines

Objective The question the audit will answer.

In scope Systems, apps, accounts, and the date range.

Out of scope Other units, unapproved changes, anything not named.

Rules Read-only unless a change is approved. No live customer data without a named approval.

Done when Evidence collected, findings written, review complete.

Example. Objective: least privilege on the shared Linux host. In scope: users, groups, sudo, world-writable paths, unexpected SUID. Out of scope: cloud console, laptops, production changes. Done when every findings row has an owner.

BEST PRACTICE

Write the scope before any test. One writer. Evidence labeled fact or inference.

FOUNDATION · LEVEL 1

Risk assessment and control categories

Domain 1, Security and Risk Management, 16%

Risk = threat using a gap against an asset

Step	Level 1 question
Asset	What are we protecting, and which CIA goal matters most?
Threat	Phishing, mistake, ransomware, lost laptop — who or what.
Vulnerability	The gap. Standing admin, no MFA, SPII in an open folder.
Rating	Likelihood and impact: low, medium, high. No fake precision.
Treatment	Avoid, reduce, transfer, or accept. Name the owner.

By form

Category	What it is	Example
Administrative	Policy, process, training, ownership.	Joiner-mover-leaver. Named incident owner.
Technical	Enforced by a system.	MFA, file permissions, logging, firewall.
Physical	Building or device.	Badge reader, locked rack, laptop cable.

By timing

Category	When it works	Example
Preventive	Stops the event.	Least privilege. MFA. Input checks.
Detective	Shows the event happened.	Auth logs. Failed-login alert.
Corrective	Limits damage and restores.	Disable account. Restore. Rotate secret.
Compensating	Covers a gap you cannot close yet.	Manual review while the control is built.

BEST PRACTICE

“Standing sudo is a confidentiality and integrity gap. Control is technical and preventive: remove the daily account from the admin group. Detective pair: alert on sudo until the change is done.”

FOUNDATION · LEVEL 1

Domains of cybersecurity

CISSP common body of knowledge · ISC2 outline effective April 15, 2024

These eight weights are applied on the pages after this one. Domain 3 is the architecture note: layers, crypto use, and what I will not design.

Domain	Wt	Best practice
1 Security and risk management	16%	Rate it, name the owner, do not accept it in silence.
2 Asset security	10%	Classify first. SPII gets the tighter rule.
3 Architecture and engineering	13%	Layers. Standard crypto. Never custom crypto.
4 Communication and network	13%	Segment. No open management port.
5 Identity and access management	13%	Least privilege. No standing admin on a daily account.
6 Assessment and testing	12%	Scope first. Evidence before opinion.
7 Security operations	13%	Log auth and admin. Fact separate from guess.
8 Software development security	10%	Deny by default. Patch the component.

Same field, operational cut

NIST CSF 2.0 names the work as Govern, Identify, Protect, Detect, Respond, Recover. I use that when a manager asks what the control does, and the eight domains when the question is which body of knowledge it belongs to.

BEST PRACTICE

Place the ticket on a domain, then use that domain’s practice. Do not skip the owner.

FOUNDATION · DOMAIN 3, 13%

Security architecture and engineering

Layers, where crypto sits, and what I will not design

Domain 3 is how a system is built so one missed control does not open the whole thing. This note is the architecture I would put under the Linux host in the permission audit. It is a design review, not a build.

Defense in depth on that host

Layer	Control	If this layer fails
Physical	Locked room, badge, cable on the laptop.	Someone can touch the box.
Network	Segment the host. No open management port.	The host is reachable by anyone on the net.
Host	Least privilege, patched, non-login service accounts.	A user account becomes admin.
Data	SPII not on the box. Encrypt what must stay.	A copied disk is readable.
Detect	Auth and sudo logs, alert on repeated failure.	The other layers fail in silence.

Crypto, Level 1

Use	Protects	Rule
In transit	Confidentiality on the wire.	TLS. No plain login over the network.
At rest	Confidentiality if the disk leaves.	Encrypt the volume that holds SPII.
Hashing	Integrity of a file or a password store.	Hash passwords. Do not store them clear.
Signing	Integrity and origin of an update.	Do not install an unsigned package.

BEST PRACTICE

I do not write my own crypto. I pick a standard, name the layer it sits on, and say which CIA goal it serves. Custom crypto is a Domain 3 failure, not a skill.

PROJECT 01 · DOMAIN 5, IAM, 13%

Linux permission and privilege audit

Least privilege · Identity and Access Management

PROBLEM

A shared Linux server had accumulated admin access. The question was not “who can log in.” It was “who can change the system, and does that match the job.”

WHAT I DID

Inventoried local users, groups, and service accounts. Reviewed sudo and group-based admin paths. Searched sensitive paths for world-writable files and directories. Flagged SUID and SGID binaries worth a second look. Mapped each finding to least privilege.

FINDINGS TABLE · REPRESENTATIVE LAB OUTPUT

Finding	Why it matters	Recommendation
Daily account in an admin group	Standing privilege is the phishing prize	Drop standing sudo. Use a named admin group and a break-glass account.
Service account with a login shell	A daemon account should not be a user	Lock the account and set a non-login shell.
World-writable file in a config path	Any local user can change the service	Tighten the mode, confirm the owner, record the change.
SUID binary outside the baseline	Unexpected SUID is a privilege path	Compare to baseline. Remove it or write the justification.

BUSINESS RESULT

A short findings list with owner and recommended change. The point of the audit is a decision, not a dump of file modes.

BEST PRACTICE

“I treat admin group membership as a risk, not a convenience. I list who has it, why they have it, and what breaks if I take it away. Then I recommend the smaller privilege.”

PROJECT 02 · DOMAIN 7, SECURITY OPERATIONS, 13%

Unknown device investigation

Also touches Domain 4, Communication and Network Security, 13%

ALERT

A user reports a device on the network that is not on the asset list. Hostname is unfamiliar. No one has claimed it.

TRIAGE ORDER

1	**Scope**	When was it seen, on which segment, and who reported it. Write the time before the theory.
2	**Identify**	Hostname, IP, MAC if available, and any user context. Missing fields stay marked unknown.
3	**Compare**	Check the asset inventory and recent change tickets. A new laptop is not the same as a rogue host.
4	**Decide**	Monitor, isolate, or escalate. Name the reason. Do not isolate a business-critical host on a hunch.
5	**Close**	Timeline, evidence, recommendation, and the inventory gap that let the device go unlisted.

WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE

A one-page investigation note: observed facts, what was checked, what is still unknown, and a containment recommendation with the business impact called out.

BEST PRACTICE

“I do not call it malicious because it is unfamiliar. I collect the identifiers, compare them to the inventory, and separate three outcomes: authorized and unlisted, shadow IT, or unknown and worth isolating. The note says which one I can support.”

PROJECTS 03 AND 04 · DOMAINS 1 AND 2

PII handling one-pager and mini risk register

Asset Security 10% · Security and Risk Management 16%

PII and SPII one-pager

A one-page handling guide for staff who touch customer or employee data. It defines PII and more sensitive SPII, gives examples, and states the rule for storage, sharing, and what to do if it leaves the approved place.

PII

Name with contact data, employee ID, account number. Needs a reason to access and an approved store.

SPII

SSN, bank or card data, government ID, health data, credentials. Stricter access, no casual email, escalate on exposure.

If exposed

Stop sharing, note what left and who received it, tell the named owner. Do not investigate alone past the first facts.

Mini risk register

Five risks a small team can actually own. Ratings are a starting scale, not a fake precision score.

Risk	L	I	Treatment
Phishing takes a user credential	H	H	Reduce: report path, MFA, short user cue
Standing admin on daily accounts	M	H	Reduce: drop standing sudo
Device not on the asset list	M	M	Reduce: inventory check on join
SPII in a drive with broad access	M	H	Reduce: classify, restrict, name owner
No named incident owner	M	M	Reduce: one owner, one backup

L = likelihood I = impact H = high M = medium. Best practice: no row is done without an owner.

CASE · GOOGLE CERTIFICATE · FICTIONAL COMPANY

Botium Toys — controls in place and missing

Single site: office, storefront, warehouse · online sales in the U.S. and the E.U.

Botium Toys develops and sells toys. The IT manager asked for an internal audit because online sales grew and the company now holds customer and card data. This is a course case, not a client engagement. Scope is the security program: assets, controls, and compliance.

Assets in scope

On-prem equipment, employee devices, the internal network, stored customer and payment data, legacy systems that still need a person, and warehouse inventory. Customers, employees, and those assets are the three things a gap can hurt.

Control	Status	Best practice it should meet
Firewall	In place	Default deny. Review the rules.
Antivirus	In place	On every endpoint, definitions current.
Locks, CCTV, fire detection	In place	Keep. Physical does not cover the data.
Least privilege	Missing	Staff see only what the job needs.
Separation of duties	Missing	No one person can both take and hide a payment.
Password policy and manager	Weak / missing	Length, uniqueness, manager, MFA on admin.
Encryption	Missing	Card and PII encrypted at rest and in transit.
IDS	Missing	Alert on intrusion. Antivirus is not detection.
Backups and disaster recovery	Missing	Tested restore. An owner. A time target.
Legacy systems	Partial	Patch or isolate. Do not leave them on the flat network.

COMPLIANCE THAT APPLIES

PCI DSS for card payments. GDPR for E.U. customers. Neither is met while access is wide and data is clear.

CASE · WHO THE GAP HITS

Risks to customers, employees, and assets

Based on controls that are missing, not on controls already in place

Who	Risk from the gap	Best practice
Customers	Card data and PII are readable and open to every employee. A stolen laptop or one phished account exposes buyers. No IDS means the leak can run unseen. E.U. buyers add a 72-hour notice duty the company cannot meet.	Encrypt. Least privilege. Log access. Name a breach owner.
Employees	Weak passwords and no manager make a staff account the easy door. Shared access means one person can be blamed for everyone's data. No separation of duties puts the honest employee in an insider-risk seat.	MFA. Unique passwords. Split payment duties. Access only for the role.
Assets	No backup and no recovery plan. Ransomware or a warehouse-system failure stops sales. Legacy boxes on the flat network are the path in. Firewall and antivirus do not restore a dead server.	Tested backups. Isolate legacy. Recovery owner and a time target.

What I would tell the IT manager

- Do first: take card and customer data off the all-staff share, then encrypt what remains.
- Same week: MFA on any account that can reach that data. A password manager. End standing access.
- Next: a backup that has been restored once, and an IDS or equivalent alert on the payment path.
- Do not claim PCI DSS or GDPR compliance until those four are in place and owned.

RATING

High. The physical controls work. The data controls do not. Customers carry the confidentiality risk, employees carry the account risk, assets carry the availability risk.

USING THIS PACKET

How to send it

Resume

Attach the one-page resume. It is written for applicant tracking systems: standard headings, no tables, no graphics.

Portfolio

Attach this PDF, or link it. In the email, name one project in a sentence so they open it.

Do not inflate

If asked whether a project was a paid job, say it was a portfolio lab. The method is the credential. A fake employer is how candidates get dropped.

Credential check

List the Google certificate as earned only after the official credential is issued. CISSP stays “in progress.”

30-SECOND INTRO

“I’m Desmond Whitlock. I’m targeting a junior SOC or security analyst seat. I work from CIA, PII versus SPII, OWASP risk classes, and a scoped team audit. The labs I can walk are a permission audit, an unknown-device investigation, a PII page, and a small risk register. I’m studying for the CISSP.”

WHAT TO BUILD NEXT

- Put these four write-ups in a public GitHub repo with the commands and a redacted sample output.
- Add one Python script that parses an auth log and flags repeated failures from one source.
- Add one SQL audit query: who accessed a sensitive table, in a time window, outside an approved role.
- When the Google credential issues, put the link on the resume. Keep CISSP as in progress until the exam is passed.